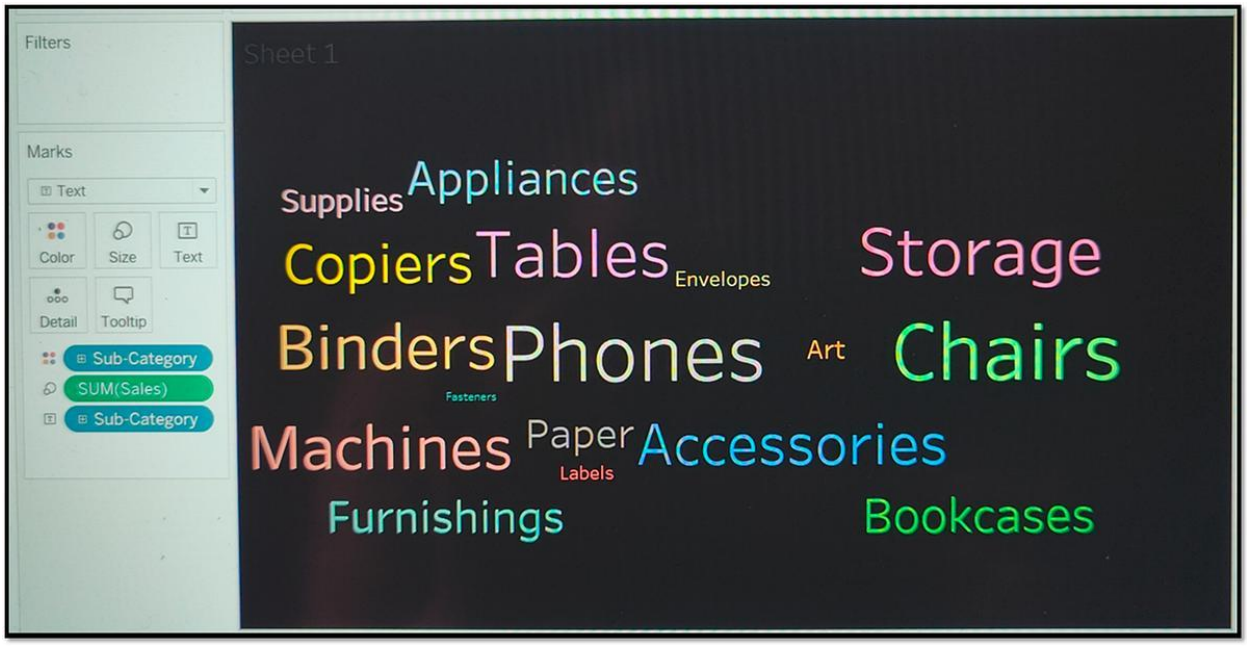
**Tableau Advanced Chart Types — Notes**

Advanced visual creation techniques:

1. Word Cloud — identify frequently occurring words or categories.
2. Text Table — display exact values in rows and columns.
3. Duplicate as Crosstab — create a tabular copy of a worksheet for detailed data inspection or export.
4. Lollipop Chart — compare values using a line and a circle instead of a conventional bar.

**1. Word Cloud**




medium.com

**What is a Word Cloud?**

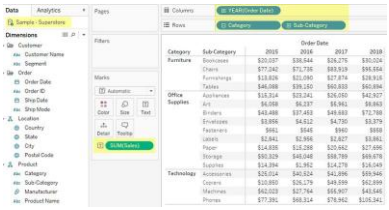
A Word Cloud is a visualization in which words appear in different font sizes, with larger words representing higher values of a selected measure.

In Tableau, a word cloud is created using the Text mark type. The size of each word can be controlled by a measure, while color can represent another measure or dimension.

**Use cases**

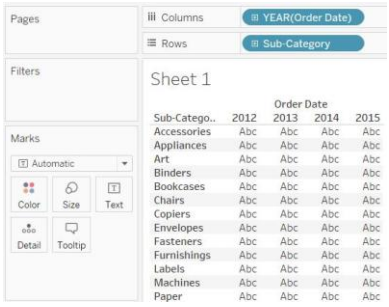
- Identify the most common product names or categories.
- Highlight popular products in a product catalogue.
- Summarize frequently occurring words in customer feedback.
- Compare products by total sales or order quantity.
- Create a quick visual summary for a presentation or dashboard.

**Steps to create a Word Cloud in Tableau**



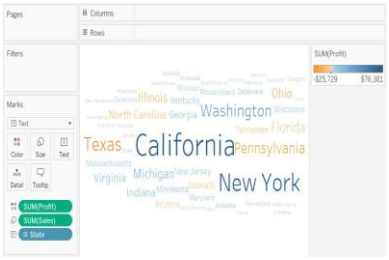
Step 1 — Connect to the dataset

Open Tableau and connect to Sample Superstore. Open a new worksheet.



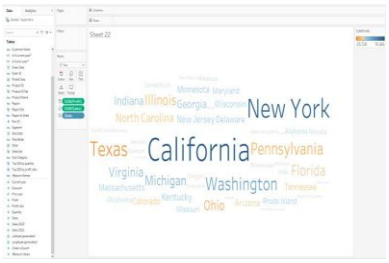

Step 2 — Select the Text mark type

On the Marks card, open the mark-type dropdown and select Text.




Step 3 — Add the product names

Drag Product Name to Text on the Marks card. Drag Sales to Size.




Step 4 — Format the visualization

Drag Profit to Color, choose a suitable color palette, and adjust font size. Use the Fit menu to make the cloud fit the view.

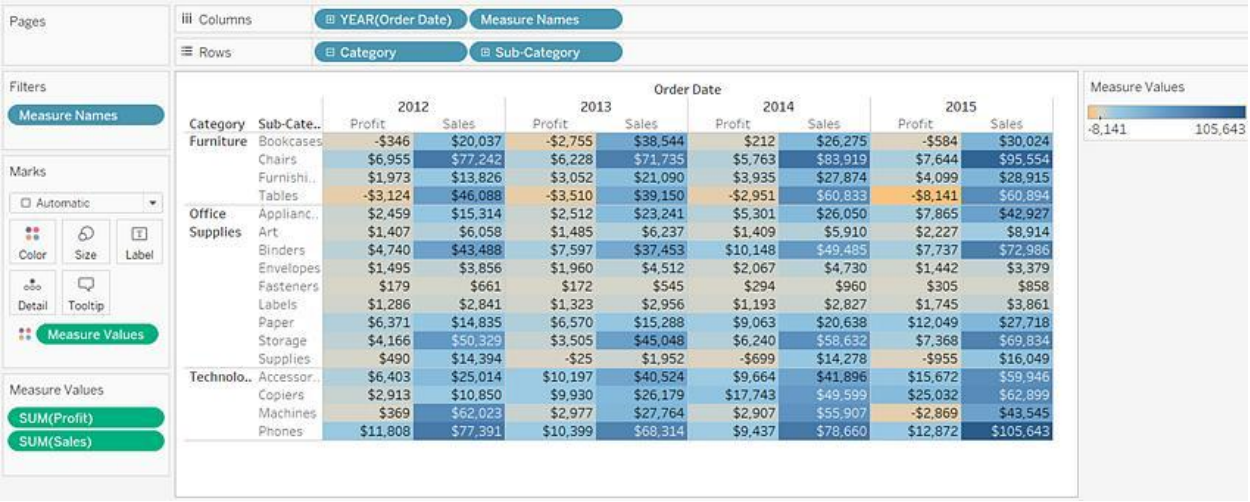
**Marks card configuration**

| **Marks property** | **Field** |
|---|---|
| Mark Type | Text |
| Text | Product Name |
| Size | SUM(Sales) |
| Color | SUM(Profit) |
| Tooltip | Sales, Profit, Quantity |

Important: Product Name can contain hundreds of distinct values. A word cloud may become crowded, so filter to the top 20–30 products by sales when necessary.

Interpretation tip: Large text means high sales in this setup. Color represents profit, so a large product name does not automatically mean it is highly profitable.

## 2. Text Table




help.tableau.com

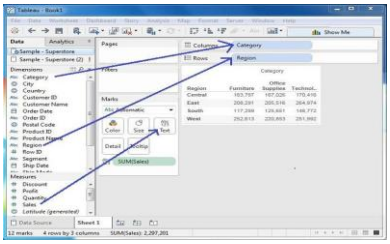
### What is a Text Table?

A Text Table, also called a highlight-free crosstab or a tabular view, displays data using text and numbers arranged in rows and columns.

Unlike a bar chart, it emphasizes exact values rather than visual comparison.

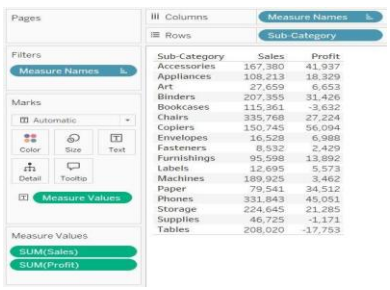
For example, a manager may want to see the sales and profit of each sub-category in every region.

### Steps to create a Text Table



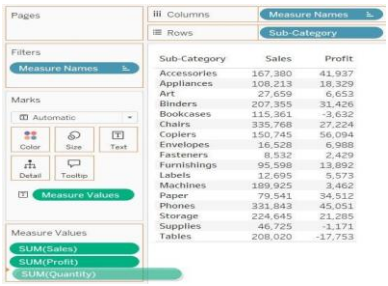
Step 1 — Create a worksheet

Open a new worksheet and rename it Sales and Profit Text Table.



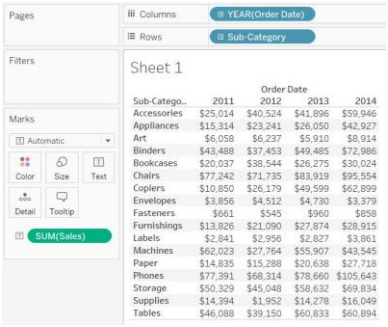

Step 2 — Add dimensions and measures

Drag Sub-Category to Rows. Drag Sales and Profit to Columns.




Step 3 — Choose Text

If necessary, select Text on the Marks card. For a standard text table, Tableau displays the measures as text in separate columns.




Step 4 — Format the table

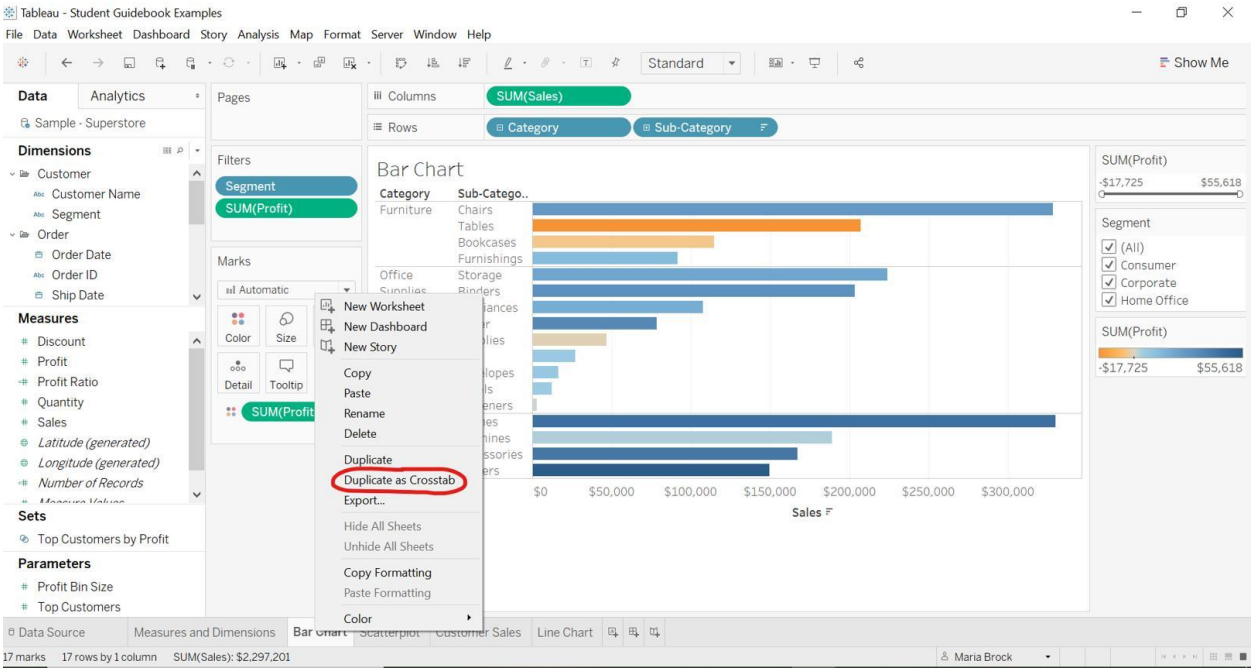
Format Sales and Profit as currency, enable totals if required, and adjust column widths and alignment.

**Recommended configuration**

| Shelf or property | Field |
|---|---|
| Rows | Sub-Category |
| Columns | Measure Names |
| Marks → Text | Measure Values |
| Measure Values | SUM(Sales), SUM(Profit) |
| Optional filter | Region |

Tip: Using Measure Names on Columns and Measure Values on Text allows you to show several measures together in a compact text table. If you place Sales and Profit directly on Columns, Tableau may instead create separate panes for the measures.

## 3. Duplicate as Crosstab



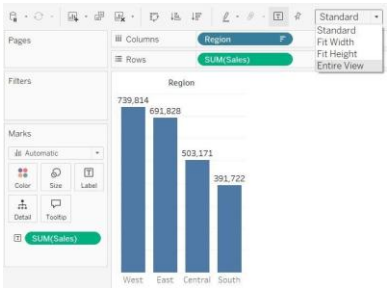

[thetableaustudentguide.com](thetableaustudentguide.com)

### What does Duplicate as Crosstab mean?

Duplicate as Crosstab is a worksheet command, not a separate chart type.

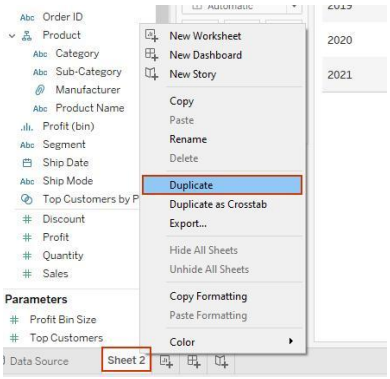
It creates a new worksheet that presents the selected worksheet's view as a text-based table or crosstab, where applicable. It is useful when you want to preserve the original visualization while creating a detailed tabular version of its data.

### Steps to use Duplicate as Crosstab



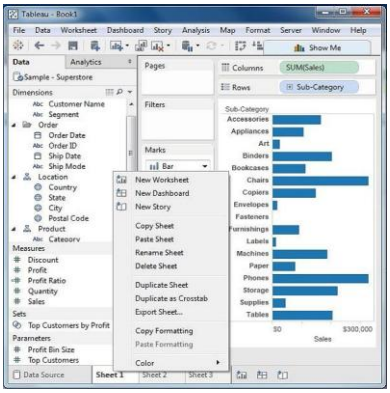

Step 1 — Create your original view

Build a chart using Region on Columns and SUM(Sales) on Rows.



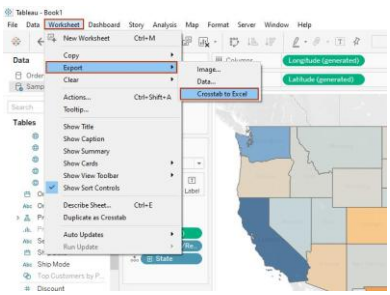

Step 2 — Open the worksheet menu

Right-click the worksheet tab at the bottom of Tableau, or open its worksheet menu.




Step 3 — Select Duplicate as Crosstab

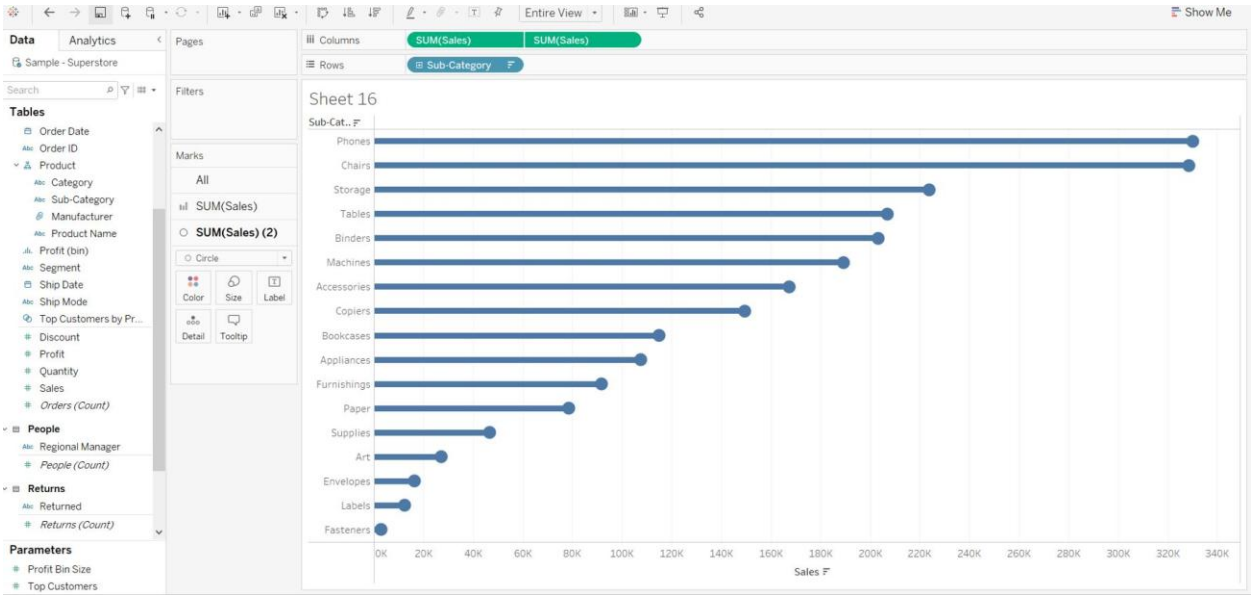
Tableau creates a separate worksheet with a crosstab representation of the original view.




Step 4 — Review or export

Verify the row and column layout. To export, use Worksheet → Export → Crosstab to Excel where available, or use Download → Crosstab on a published view when supported.

## 4. Lollipop Chart




thedataschool.com

### What is a Lollipop Chart?

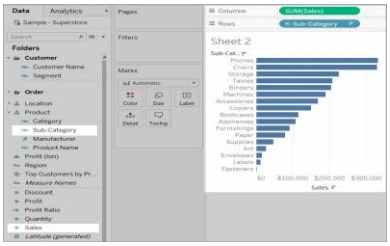
A Lollipop Chart is a variation of a bar chart. It uses a thin line and a circle at the end to represent the value of each category.

The line extends from a baseline to the value, and the circle highlights the endpoint.

A lollipop chart is useful when you want to compare categories with a cleaner, less visually heavy design than a traditional bar chart.

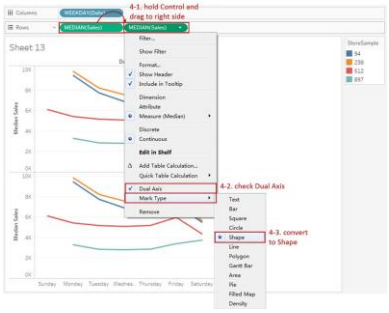
### Steps to create a Lollipop Chart in Tableau

Tableau does not provide a dedicated Lollipop Chart mark type. You can create one using a dual-axis chart with a line and a circle.



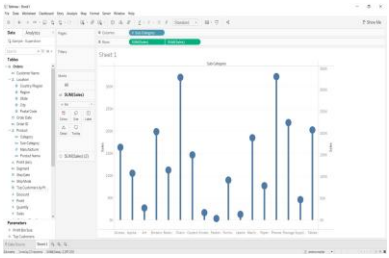
Step 1 — Build a basic bar chart

Drag Sub-Category to Rows and Sales to Columns. Keep the aggregation as SUM(Sales).



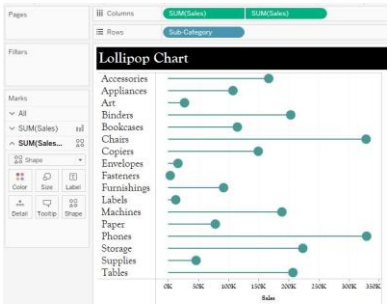

Step 2 — Create a second axis

Drag a second copy of Sales onto Columns. Right-click the second axis and select Dual Axis.



Step 3 — Change the mark types

On the first SUM(Sales) Marks card, select Line. On the second SUM(Sales) Marks card, select Circle.




Step 4 — Format the lollipops

Increase the circle size, reduce the line thickness, and choose contrasting colors if desired. Sort sub-categories by Sales in descending order.

**Recommended configuration**

| Property | Configuration |
|---|---|
| Rows | Sub-Category |
| Columns | SUM(Sales), twice |
| First Marks card | Line |
| Second Marks card | Circle |
| Sort | Sales, descending |
| Tooltip | Sub-Category, Sales, Profit |

**5. Quick revision sheet**

| Visualization | Main purpose | Superstore example | Key Tableau feature |
|---|---|---|---|
| Word Cloud | Highlight values through text size | Product names by sales | Text mark + Size |
| Text Table | Read exact values | Sales and profit by sub-category | Rows, Columns, Text |
| Duplicate as Crosstab | Convert an existing view into tabular form | Regional sales chart to table | Worksheet tab menu |
| Lollipop Chart | Compare category values with less visual weight | Sales by sub-category | Dual Axis + Line + Circle |

**6. Practice exercises**

Use Sample Superstore to complete these tasks yourself.

**Practice checklist**

0 of 4 complete

Word Cloud

Show Product Name sized by SUM(Sales) and colored by SUM(Profit).

Tip: Filter to the top 20 products by sales.

Text Table

Show Sub-Category, Sales, Profit, and Quantity.

Tip: Format Sales and Profit as currency.

Duplicate as Crosstab

Create a regional sales bar chart and duplicate it as a crosstab.

Tip: Compare the original chart with the tabular worksheet.

Lollipop Chart

Compare Sales across Sub-Category using a dual axis.

Tip: Use Line for one axis and Circle for the other.